

SARMAD AHSAN

Senior OpenShift Consultant

Red Hat OpenShift · ACM · ACS · ODF · GitOps · OpenShift AI · PCI-DSS / SAMA banking

Lahore, Pakistan · Open to Saudi Arabia, UAE and remote

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior OpenShift consultant with 7+ years in Linux, DevOps and Red Hat platforms, and 3+ years running production OpenShift for regulated clients. Most recently resident consultant for Dell Technologies at a MENA tier-1 bank (PCI-DSS Level 1, SAMA) in Riyadh, owning Day-2 operations across DC, DMZ and DR clusters: upgrades, SCC and RBAC, certificate lifecycle, audit evidence and capacity. Earlier delivered OpenShift, ODF, RHV, Red Hat SSO and PAM for banks, a national telecom operator and MSP clients. Writes his own Python and Bash tooling, and is extending the platform into OpenShift AI and NVIDIA GPU workloads.

CORE SKILLS

OpenShift / Kubernetes: OCP 4.x install (IPI/UPI, bare metal, vSphere), upgrades, Single-Node OpenShift, Operators/OLM, MachineConfig, SCC, NetworkPolicy, quotas, etcd backup, Day-2 operations

Red Hat portfolio: Advanced Cluster Management (ACM), Advanced Cluster Security (ACS), ODF/Ceph, Quay, OpenShift GitOps (Argo CD), OpenShift Pipelines (Tekton), RHV, Ansible / AAP, Red Hat SSO (Keycloak), Process Automation Manager, OpenShift AI

Security & compliance: PCI-DSS, SAMA Cyber Security Framework, RBAC/LDAP, TLS certificate lifecycle, zero-trust network segmentation (DC/DMZ), Prisma Cloud

Observability: Prometheus/PromQL, Grafana, Alertmanager, Dynatrace, ELK

Automation: Ansible, Bash, Python, Helm, Kustomize, Terraform, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Git

Middleware on OpenShift: Red Hat SSO (Keycloak), Process Automation Manager, 3scale API Management, AMQ Broker, IBM Cloud Pak — platform-level deployment for application teams

Infrastructure: RHEL, VMware vSphere, Proxmox VE, Commvault, NVIDIA GPU Operator (lab)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Resident OpenShift Consultant

2024 – 2026

Dell Technologies — client: a MENA tier-1 bank

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Resident consultant for Dell Technologies on the OpenShift platform of a PCI-DSS Level 1 digital bank regulated by SAMA. Platform team role (Day-2 operations, upgrades, security, audit evidence) inside the bank's segregated L1–L3 support model.

- Operated production Red Hat OpenShift 4.16/4.17 across segregated internal (DC) and DMZ clusters, plus pre-production and DR environments.
- Planned the 4.16 → 4.17 upgrade path, including operator-catalog compatibility checks for the DMZ cluster.
- Renewed ingress and API TLS certificates across DC, DMZ and DR environments; wrote the renewal runbooks and an expiry-tracking process.
- Fixed restricted-v2 SCC UID/GID failures for application teams without granting privileged or anyuid access.
- Delivered user-access and RBAC audits for PCI-DSS and SAMA evidence using a self-built, LDAP-aware Python auditor (CSV reports by user and by role).
- Built a Python CRI-O image-prune tool (single- and multi-cluster, dry-run, HTML reports) to clear node DiskPressure; wrote runbooks for root-disk extension and graceful node reboots.
- Built a Prometheus/PromQL capacity-utilization reporter (Python, pandas, Plotly, Jinja2) for capacity planning and audit evidence.
- Sized RHACM 2.14 and Quay 3.15 roll-outs; supported Dynatrace monitoring (ActiveGate diagnostics and support archives).

OpenShift Administrator

2022 – 2024

Systems Limited

Lahore, Pakistan

Red Hat platform team of a large managed-service provider, delivering OpenShift, ODF, PAM, SSO, Ansible and RHEL for banking, telecom and MSP clients.

- Installed, upgraded and administered OpenShift 4.x clusters (4.10 → 4.16) for banking, telecom and MSP clients, including HA and disaster-recovery designs.
- Deployed OpenShift Data Foundation (ODF/Ceph) for banks to replace NFS and SAN storage; configured CSI drivers and storage classes.

- Built and deployed custom solutions on Red Hat Process Automation Manager (PAM) and Red Hat SSO (Keycloak), including LDAP/AD integration.
- Managed OpenShift and Red Hat Virtualization (RHV) clusters for a national telecom operator; deployed and tested Red Hat 3scale API Management and AMQ Broker on OpenShift for the application team (pre-production lab stage).
- Deployed IBM Cloud Pak on OpenShift for the application team of a leading Pakistani bank, with supporting components on dedicated RHEL hosts.
- Managed operators and integrated security tooling (Prisma Cloud); tuned cluster and storage performance.
- Automated builds and Day-2 tasks with Ansible; trained and mentored engineers on OpenShift.

Platform Engineer — OpenShift AI & GPU Lab (independent)

2026 – Present

Self-directed

Lahore, Pakistan

- Built a Proxmox VE 9 lab on a Lenovo ThinkStation P920 with NVIDIA RTX 3060 GPU passthrough to run Single-Node OpenShift for OpenShift AI, NVIDIA GPU Operator, OpenShift Virtualization and ODF-LVM work.
- Preparing for Red Hat EX280 / EX380 (RHCA in OpenShift track) and NVIDIA NCA-AIIO.

DevOps Engineer

2020 – 2022

New Worlds Solutions

Lahore, Pakistan

- Containerized applications and ran them on Docker, Kubernetes and OpenShift.
- Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and Ansible; automated VM and host provisioning.
- Managed Linux servers, MS SQL, SSL certificates, DNS, SMTP and SFTP; resolved application and system performance issues.

Linux Administrator

2019 – 2020

Ghanimah Labs

Remote (Canada / UK)

- Ran RHEL and Ubuntu infrastructure across 3 production environments; automated configuration with Ansible.
- Hardened systems (SELinux, RBAC, firewalls); monitored with Nagios, Zabbix and ELK; configured bonding, teaming and VLANs.

PROJECTS & TOOLS

Own tools: CRI-O image prune (Python, async, HTML reports) · Prometheus capacity reporter · LDAP-aware RBAC auditor · node connectivity checker (oc debug) · ODF storage-usage reporter · DiskPressure and certificate-renewal runbooks.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science — coursework completed

ULM University, Faisalabad

Associate Degree (ADP) in Computer Science

2017 – 2019

GC University Faisalabad

Languages: English (professional), Urdu (native)